EA-02-05-S
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Replaces:
IT Policy 185.20
EA-02-01-S

NETWORK CONNECTIVITY ENTERPRISE SERVICE STANDARD

See Also:
RCW 43.105.006 WaTech Purpose
RCW 43.105.020 Definitions
RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance
RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security

PURPOSE

This standard establishes the statewide service capability, Network Connectivity, as an enterprise service under EA-02 – Establishing an Enterprise Service Policy. A Washington state agency must not adopt, build, expand, or renew a service with similar capabilities unless it has an approved waiver or exemption (see Section 5).

SCOPE

The Network Connectivity capabilities listed in Section 4 must be used to ensure secure, reliable, centralized, and standardized access to enterprise network resources, systems, and data.

APPLICABILITY

This standard applies to all state agencies (as defined in RCW 43.105.020) and their organizational users (including employees, contractors, partners, and vendors) to access internal state resources.

This standard does not apply to the K-20 network, institutions of higher education, legislature, judiciary, or local governments.

ENTERPRISE SERVICE CAPABILITIES

The Network Connectivity enterprise service designation encompasses the following capabilities:

1. Domain Name Services (DNS) – available to all agencies connected to the State Government Network (SGN) for name resolution and authoritative hosting for the wa.gov and wa.us domains.
2. Dedicated Cloud Connectivity – delivers secure, high-speed connectivity to mission-critical cloud services to ensure reliable performance and availability.

3. Network Core Services – the networking infrastructure and technology that provides state agencies and other authorized customers connectivity to the state's wide area network (WAN) and SGN hosted systems and data.
4. Transport & Connectivity – provides end to end design, provisioning, implementation, and operations support for an agency's physical and virtual networks.
5. Wireless – provides secure, centrally managed statewide wireless connectivity that enables mobility and productivity using a common, supported infrastructure for your agency's network.
6. Network Time Protocol (NTP) – provides SGN connected agencies with network-synchronized time.
7. Internet Protocol (IP) version 4 and version 6 – network identification and location address allocations

WAIVERS AND EXEMPTIONS TO THIS STANDARD

In accordance with POL-01-02-S Technology Policy and Standard Waiver Request Standard, agencies may qualify for a waiver or exemption from compliance with this standard. Agencies may request an exemption for situations that meet one of the following criteria.

1. **Exemptions Apply to Transport and Connectivity Capabilities**
    a. Fiber optic network connectivity owned by a state agency is exempt.
    b. Isolated or segmented, non-SGN networks used for specialized purposes (e.g., federally regulated, public safety, transportation systems).
2. **Exemptions Apply to Wireless Capability**
    a. Wireless networks that do not connect to the SGN.
    b. Wireless networks that require end-to-end encryption (e.g., FIPS).
    c. Wireless networks that require network micro-segregation (e.g., TrustSec).
    d. Wireless networks that require RFID or Bluetooth tracking.

AUTHORITY

This standard is issued under the authority of RCW 43.105.054, which grants Washington Technology Solutions authority to establish statewide technology standards and enterprise services, including wireless communications systems. RCW 43.105.006 establishes Washington Technology Solutions as the centralized provider of broadly used and uniform technology services. RCW 43.105.450 requires state agencies to comply with statewide information technology security policies and standards.

REFERENCES

1. Service Catalog: WaTech Network Connectivity
2. Definition of Terms Used in Policies and Reports
3. MGMT-01-01-S Technology Portfolio Foundation – Application Standard
4. POL-01-01-PR Technology Policies and Standards Waiver Procedure
5. RCW 43.105.006 WaTech Purpose
6. RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance
7. RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security
8. SEC-04-05-S Network Security Standard
9. SEC-06 Access Control Policy
10. SEC-06-02-S Remote Access Standard
11. SEC-08-01-S Data Classification Standard
12. SEC-08-02-S Encryption Standard
13. Enterprise Security Standards

CONTACT INFORMATION

For questions about this policy, please email the WaTech Policy Mailbox.